Europe section. So, I decided it was my turn to try to fill the gap.

Fast forward almost two decades, the ignorance has taken another, probably unexpected turn, and the gap between the two halves of Europe another character: that of perception of values. Or so it seems, calling for a fresh interpretation.

Indeed, the issue of the rule of law (to which I dedicate the final chapter), the attitudes to migration, views on the so-called ‘sexual democracy’ etc. have raised eyebrows in Brussels and in most of the Western capitals, especially with regards to Poland and Hungary. While some of these developments have more to do with an ordinary power-grab than ideology, it is essential to look at what is behind them – something that few if any analysts have dared to do. One of the key messages of this book is that these developments in the region have a lot to do with the political, social and cultural history of Central and Eastern Europe before World War II. This is, in short, what the first part of the book is about.

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2. Accession Monitoring Report, A8 Countries, May 2004 – March 2007, Home Office, May 2007.